



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

All British Day

We have missed them. The day when British car enthusiasts gathered together with their cars and provide the opportunity to do what we all enjoy doing, talking about our cars.

When these trying days have

passed we will once again be able see what our fellow enthusiast have been up to over the last two years.

In the meantime please enjoy the photos below from years passed by.



VOL. 8 ISSUE #9
Sept 2021

COMING EVENTS

September

2nd	General Meeting
4th	Retford Park
11th	Concours Workshop
15th	Committee Meeting

October

7th	General Meeting
13th	Committee Meeting

Please note that all meetings will be via Zoom until further notice.

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POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au

WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Normally our monthly meetings will be held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the restaurant from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Another month, another variation on the lockdown rules and no end in sight. Still, I expect many of you, like Louise and me, have now been vaccinated, which is one more step on the way out of lockdowns. Although current vaccination rates lead me to think that our General Meetings will be on Zoom for at least September and October.

I'm really hoping that the Victorian Mini-Rally will be able to go ahead in November, and those intrepid members who have signed up for the 'Mildura Meander' will be able to get together and enjoy the run. I'm sure that we will be able to accommodate a few more members, should you wish to join us. Just give me a call or email to book. Contact details are below.

It would be really good to see more of our country members join in the Zoom meetings. Distance might exclude them from attending in person, but Zoom allows

members to join in from wherever they happen to be locked-down, and in these days of physical isolation, any opportunity to socialise ought to be taken and enjoyed.

To join in our 2nd September General Meeting the invitation link is, as usual:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/89690407645?pwd=Sm-JPNVQrRStnYko2bnRHR-GLSSGp2dz09>

Or just open Zoom and join:
Meeting ID: 896 9040 7645
Passcode: 297053

Elsewhere you will read about my new windscreen. Thinking about windscreens reminds me of the pleasure of driving a '100' with the screen down. It's not something I do much these days, but in my early Austin-Healey years in England it was a regular part of every summer to drop the screen and cruise the back lanes at a relaxed 30 or so mph with



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

the breeze through my hair (I had plenty in those days) and the scents of the fields and woods in the air. Somehow, not having that piece of glass in front of my face made the experience more intense and more pleasurable. Except of course if a farmer had been muck-spreading, but then, that's not too pleasant even with the screen up.

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COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

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joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
stirton@bigpond.net.au

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Historic Vehicle Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the September 2021 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

You really don't know how lucky you are. There I was quite prepared to write a 1,000 + words on my new Spear and Jackson Round End shovel. It would have been a treatise to do Eric Olthwaite proud; however it probably wouldn't have impressed anyone who wanted to read about Austin-Healeys.

Nothing interesting was appearing in the inbox until Secretary Julie sent a message daring me to write an article on the shovel. The grey cells kicked into gear while I worked out what subjects could be written about while discussing the attributes of a new shovel. I responded to Julie with a list of headings on aspects of shovel ownership that was 442 words long. So it looked as if the Pulitzer Prize winning shovel novel was going to end up much longer than 1,000 words.

All of a sudden the cavalry arrived in the form of five separate articles from members. So you can thank Allan Whitehouse for telling us about buying his new tyres; Denis Kasza for explaining the problems

he has been having with the Borg-Warner overdrive in his Austin Westminster; Gordon Lynas telling us why he bought a new windscreen for his 100 and how to fit it; How Colin Rule has been twiddling his thumbs by making half scale Webers and dismantling his BJ8; and lastly we can follow Ray Roberts' instructions of converting the windscreen wiper motor in your Austin-Healey into a two-speed. On behalf of everyone, thanks to the five of you. Now did I tell you about the new garden rake?

But wait there's more! There are also articles on the pluses of owning a gas torch; how to bleed four-wheel drum brakes fitted to Austin-Healeys; and, sadly mentions on the deaths of Graham Robson and Louise (King) Collins. Thank you also to Bryan Levy for the photo of his birthday present.

You would have noticed from the

below photo that a bumper has appeared on the back of the Quinn Austin-Healey. An interesting exercise fitting a new bumper to almost 70 year old bumper irons. Surely everything just easily goes together a little like Meccano. Well not quite, as none of the holes lined up at all. It was time to phone a friend, in fact two. Firstly Colin Rule told me about a batch of new rear bumpers that are hardly worth scrapping. So a call to George Goodare was in order who advised to fit the irons, overrides and the bar using to start with just a couple of threads of the nuts and bolts. Then slowly tighten all eight fasteners bit by bit until they are all done. It worked! As you can see the reflector pods have yet to be fitted.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and I look forward to receiving your photos and words which would have to be a lot better than a bunch of words on a shovel.





Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 5 August 2021.

Commenced: 7:35pm.

Venue - Zoom Video Conference

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

There were no visitors or new members.

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Glenn Barnes, Mal French, Garry Lee, Greg Poole, Patrick & Caroline Quinn, Doug & Pamela Ross

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 1 July 2021, as published in the August 2021 issue of *Flat Chat*, be accepted as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon provided an update on the Zoom meeting of the Australian clubs on 12 July, which he and Jim had attended, to discuss future National Rallies.

In normal circumstances, SA would have been next to host the National Rally, but they'd decided to pass. Queensland was next in line but they'd advised that they wouldn't be prepared to take one on for a couple of years. NSW were next, and we offered to host one in 2024, but apparently WA were keen to do a wildflower rally in 2024 and were already well-advanced in their planning. So the upshot was that we've ceded 2024 to WA and NSW will host a Rally in 2025. Or if the Committee thought it wasn't too much risk, we could try for 2023. Gordon was to follow up with WA just to check on their readiness for 2024.

All clubs at the meeting had agreed that National Rallies were still an important future event, but it was possible the format might change. This would be up to individual clubs.

Gordon advised that the Victorian club had increased the number of allowable attendees for the mini-rally in Mildura (on the assumption that it would still be OK to go ahead!). He also reminded members about his Mildura Meander which would be joining up with the Rally.

Gordon provided a brief background on Graham

Healey (grandson of DMH), who'd been a member of the Club for quite a few years. At the last Committee meeting it was proposed that Graham be made an honorary member of the Club. Gordon read out the criteria for honorary membership, with the idea receiving lots of support.

Resolved, unanimously, that Graham Healey be made an honorary member of the Austin-Healey Owners' Club (NSW) Inc.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Geoff had nothing particular to report but was pleased to advise that he was nice and warm, as opposed to being cold and miserable at the last meeting!

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie advised of snail mail received:

- The Australian Jaguar Driver – July
- Nine membership renewals

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- Healeys West (WA) – August
- Speed Read (MSA) – July & August
- Rally Directions (CRC) – July
- The Preserve (CMC) – August
- Healey Torque (Qld) – July & August
- Motorlife News – August

Other emails received:

- Advice from the Victorian club that Bill Metcalf had been elected as President, with Terry Wade as Vice President
- Notification from the CMC that the Shannons Sydney Classic had been postponed
- Notification that the East Hills Charity Car Show had been postponed until 31 October, at Kelso Oval South in Panania
- A number of emails from members about membership payments/status
- Invitation to the "Crooz and Chooz" Car Show at Lake George Vineyard, 24 October 2021 (it was formerly known as the Wagging Tails Community Car Show)

TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised of the Club's funds as at 31 July 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$23,135.06



Cash Reserve	\$12,500.18
Charlie's Run	\$2,554.05
Term Deposit	\$78,945.63

Receipts for the month included \$5,155 in membership renewals and \$220 for sale of a BN1 wind-screen. The lone payment was for \$89.97, being 3 months of the Adobe software (used for *Flat Chat*).

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Given the status of social events, Bruce's report was a bit shorter than usual. Most events were tentative only, dependent on lockdown, case numbers etc.

Bruce had been in contact with Retford Park and they'd advised they were fine to bill the Club only a few days in advance of the planned visit.

Bruce asked members to let him know if they had any ideas for 2022 events. He also advised that ABC iView was running old episodes of Torque, with Peter Wherrett

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report from Pamela, but Gordon advised that Doug had gone into hospital the previous day to sort out an eye problem. Geoff advised that Vince had (finally!) had his knee operation done the previous day. Everyone wished them both the best.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim advised he'd gradually been cancelling events on the website, but he'd recently added details for the Mildura Meander. He'd also uploaded lots of photos to the website, courtesy of Alan Mitchell. If members had any car-related photos, could they please send them to Jim for the website.

MEMBERSHIP

Christine advised that 16 members hadn't rejoined, including six on Historic Vehicle Registration who hadn't rejoined. A new associate member had joined the previous day. She confirmed that Club member Robert Harrison (from Whale Beach) had passed away, but his son David had taken over Robert's car and was going to join.

EDITOR'S REPORT

No report

HISTORIC VEHICLE REGISTRATION

No report

HISTORIAN

No report

LIBRARIAN

No report

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

No report

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross advised he hadn't heard anything further from Parramatta Park about the DMH Display Day, so he would follow up with them. At this stage, 24 October was still in the mix.

CMC REPORT

In the absence of much other entertainment, Ray said he was actually looking forward to boring CMC meetings!

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

Christine advised there'd been no meetings and the All British Day had been cancelled. She also advised that Rob Allen from the Sprite Club had passed away.

CSCA REPORT

Sadly, the Newcastle Supersprint had been cancelled, yet another COVID victim. That left only the Jaguar and Triumph meetings for the rest of the year.

In response to Julie's comment earlier in the meeting about being utterly fed up with hearing the word "unprecedented", Colin managed to use it 11 times in the space of his short report – a sterling effort!

Colin Goldsmith thanked Colin Rule for his assistance with getting the spring sorted out for his Alvis bonnet. He promised to tell the story when the Club next met in person.

REGALIA

Colin Rule's virtual regalia session (JL: and no, that doesn't mean the items aren't real!) including the following:

- four x 100 and two x 100/6 windscreens left

- Phillip Bloom had a list of items for sale, including four jack stands in good condition (\$20 each), two sets of metric and AF allen keys in pouches, set of BSW taps and dies, vacuum tester for SU carbs, steel workbench with timber top, grinder, vice, finisher (1m x 2m)

Not regalia-related, but Colin advised everyone that he'd started work on his BJ8 that day. He also showed off his half-scale Weber carb to much admiration!

Gordon's report on how pleased he was with his new windscreen was followed by some great stories from members about getting rained on.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Terry advised that the tyres advertised in Flat Chat had gone. He also talked about a Swallow Doretti which was available on Bring A Trailer.

Alan Mitchell advised that he was parting with his

Mustang, which was RHD and all original. He was looking for \$50K ONO.

David Mould had for sale a big Dodge 1958 Coronet Lancer. These had been used by the Missouri highway patrol as pursuit cars. David, who'd owned it for 22 years, was looking for \$50K.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Geoff Smith referred to an article from the CMC magazine about having to specifically state that life members were fully paid members. Gordon Lynas read from the Club's constitution about life members, noting that we seemed to have it covered.

As he'd been a bit quiet, Peter Van Dyke was asked to sign everyone out by talking about his Jensen-Healey, which then led to some more good car stories!

Meeting concluded at 9.00 pm.

President's Message Cont'



100 with screen down – N York Moors c. 1968

Thinking of those times makes me think of my favourite roads. There were quite a few in North Yorkshire, but there isn't much point in sharing those with you. So, what are my favourite roads in NSW? One certainly has to be the coast road between Bermagui and Tathra. Nearer to home is the road from Peats Ridge to Wollombi, which has the benefit of a characterful country pub at the Wollombi end. I could mention many more and I'm sure that you will each have your favourites.

Perhaps you could share them with us and send Patrick a photo or two? That way our members can also enjoy those journeys. (Excellent idea! PQ)

Happy Healeying,
Gordon



Somewhere on Charlie's Run 2011

There are ten memberships who have not renewed this year.

To align with the types of membership on the website, there has been an alteration to the full membership type. The full membership covers up to two people which it will continue to do, though we are listing the type to reflect the whether it's for an 'Individual' or 'Partner/Couple'. This does not make any changes to your membership with the AHOC. Looking at the below chart you will note even though I have divided the Associate, Life Membership, Honorary and Overseas below in the dissection in the table there is no change to their types on the website.

We have one new associate member this month – Frank Van Den Berg from Gladesville is looking to purchase an Austin-Healey. Welcome Frank and hope we will see you at an event or meeting once we are back to meeting again.

The September General Meeting once again will be held by Zoom due to lockdown. As you probably know the meeting is this Thursday 2 September at 7.30pm, and you should have received an email with the link to Zoom

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



to remind you to join the meeting.

Please remember, we can only have details correct about you, if you advise us and update them, so keep me let me know of your changes to phone numbers, email addresses and home address. Also, even if you make the changes yourself to your details on the website let me know to the email address above. On the subject of the website I have noticed that there are a lot of photographs added to members on the website. Thanks for taking the time to have a look at the website.

The current membership dissection is as follows and in the meantime keep safe and well.

Christine Lyttle.

Membership Type	Number of Memberships	Number of Members
Full – Individual	53	53
Full – Partner/Couple	102	204
Associate – Individual	6	6
Associate – Partner/Couple	2	4
Family	2	7
Life Member – Individual	2	2
Life Member – Partner/Couple	8	16
Patron	1	1
Honorary – Individual	1	1
Honorary – Partner/Couple	1	2
Overseas - Partner/Couple	2	4
	180	300

Social Report

Bruce Ewan

0432 096 493

bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Planning is now well underway for 2022. Most of us are looking to get out, experience and see, spend time with and meet new friends. So with that please feel free to reach out and make suggestions for content and ideas to be added into the 2022 agenda.

With all NSW locked down till September 10, Retford Park unfortunately will be held over to the new year.

Likewise, the September technical workshop.

For those looking to experience travel whilst passports are still locked away, the Cherry Festival planned for August was shown on Gardening Australia. ABC's iView app is a real treasure, including an amazing amount of content. As a preview to what was missed:- <https://www.abc.net.au/gardening/factsheets/2021-series-32-episode-22/13507968>

October is an unknown, so please keep listening.

Keep safe and live by the rules.



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Another relatively quiet month with a few renewals and no one deciding to place their car on Historic Vehicle Registration.

Our numbers have dropped to 202 cars registered through the AHOC of which there are 117 marque vehicles. The decline in numbers is due purely to some owners not renewing their AHOC membership for the 2021/22 year. As we all know there are very few rules for Historic Vehicle Registration dictated by Transport for NSW, but one is that you "must be a member of a recognised historic vehicle club". So for those who have not renewed it also means that their car is no longer reg-

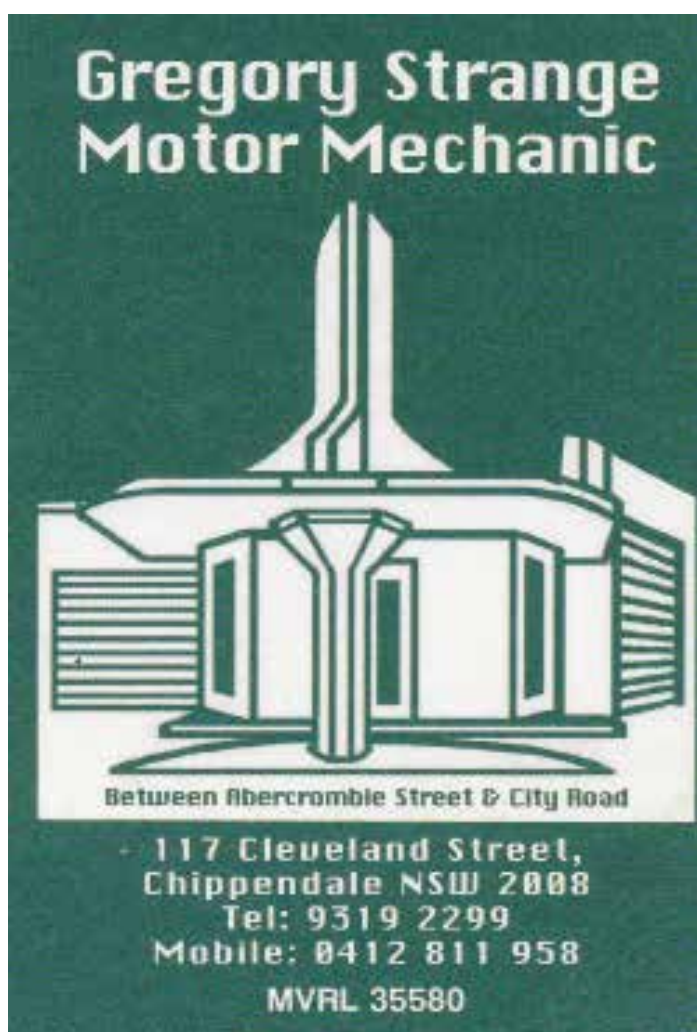
istered as a Historic Vehicle. They could of course have joined another club and changed the recorded details with Transport for NSW, which is perfectly okay. Each has been communicated with and advised that their lapse of membership also means their vehicle is no longer registered.

I think it's worthwhile repeating what you can do with your Historic Registered vehicle during periods of lockdown. Like most things with Historic Vehicle Registration the answer is simple, you use the vehicle in exactly the same way as you would use your fully registered car. In other words you use it for necessary journeys only, which is the same as your everyday car. The only extra step is to remember to fill in the log book.

If you need to do shopping, you can use your Historically Registered car providing you can show that you are going to Coles, Woolies etc. Just as it's not possible to drive your everyday car to Palm Beach for a coffee on a sunny Sunday morning, you can't do it either in your vehicle that carries Historic Vehicle Registration. However I will say that it's probably prudent to leave your Historic registered vehicle in the garage, as they do draw attention.

Please remember the steps when renewing your Historic Vehicle Registration:-

- Once you have received the renewal, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 for their contact details.
- Complete the left hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers..



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Webmaster's Report

by Jim Phillips



There are a few features on our website which members can make use of subject to some input from members.

One, which has been there from the outset, is the classified ads. There is one ad now on the website for a car for sale. Putting it up was a bit of a learning curve for both our member and the webmaster, but it was achieved. You can do it yourself by logging in to your membership under classified ads and following the bouncing ball. When you hit the submit button it then comes to me to approve and then it is live on our site. If you are having difficulties get in touch with me (0423 589 306 is best method) and I can fill in the details which you can then approve on your membership portal and so onto the website.

The other feature, which was only just released this week, is the Technical Resources section. In this section we can put all the articles of how to do things on your Austin-Healey. From the early days of Flat Chat there have been articles about how to fix stuff on your Austin-Healey and I now hope to capture these and all the other bits of "corporate knowledge" that exists in our club. There will be chapters for the various aspects with the articles on the subject con-

tained in the chapter which should assist in locating information. Over the next few weeks and months, I will scan the articles that I am able to, but would really appreciate receiving articles from members that they may already have contributed or have in their possession that may assist other members in tinkering with their Austin-Healeys.

Member options

- ▶ [Membership details](#)
- ▶ [Cars](#)
- ▶ [Club points](#)
- ▶ [Competition results](#)
- ▶ [Payments](#)
- ▶ [Events calendar](#)
- ▶ [Events list](#)
- ▶ [Classified ads](#)
- ▶ [Forums](#)
- ▶ [Newsletters](#)
- ▶ [Meeting minutes](#)
- ▶ [Technical resources](#)
- ▶ [Library](#)
- ▶ [Club constitution](#)
- ▶ [Change password](#)
- ▶ [Logout](#)

All feedback on the website is appreciated as I endeavour to make it more relevant to our members.



Original Cadillac V8 powered Healey Silverstone and modern replica.

Vale Graham Robson and Louise (King) Collins

By Patrick Quinn

This month we bring the sad news of the passing of both Graham Robson and Louise Collins.

If you have any sort of book collection covering British cars including Austin-Healeys, you will probably have one written by Graham Robson, as throughout his career he penned close to 170 books. I certainly do.

Some years back I had the pleasure of meeting Graham in Sydney when he gave a talk at Macquarie University to interested people. Later I had the occasion of reviewing one of his books (one that I am sure he just put his name to) and I can't say that I treated it too kindly. However Graham was a professional and he wrote thanking me for the review saying that the errors would be rectified in subsequent reprints. It was reprinted with the changes.

This led to an email exchange that in turn led to him writing for the *Australian Austin-Healey*. I must admit that I was pleased at how it all eventuated. Sadly Graham died on August 6th at the age of 85.

While there will be further words on Graham in the *Australian Austin-Healey*, within this issue of *Flat Chat* I am including some thoughts by Austin-Healey owner Gary Anderson, from Oregon.

Graham Robson
By Gary Anderson

We're going to miss Graham Robson. This most prolific researcher and writer about classic cars and motorsports – with nearly 170 books to his credit – passed on Friday, August 6 at the age of 85 after sustaining a fall a few months earlier. I took the picture below on a visit to his home on his 80th birthday, which he celebrated in traditional style with a dinner at a country inn surrounded by the group of noteworthy motorsports editors, writers and publishers who had been his friends since he was a young journalist and rally co-driver. For a detailed and absolutely accurate obituary of his life (he wrote it himself a few months ago to make sure the facts would be correct) go to <https://www.classicandsportscar.com/.../rip-graham-robson...>

Through Gary's editorship of *The Austin-Healey Magazine* he became a close friend of Graham and I thought his words were most descriptive. Thank you Gary.

Our second sad passing notation concerns Louise (King) Collins who I suspect many would have not have heard of.

In 2013 I noticed two photos of Louise in the book *Donald Healey – My World of Cars*. Intrigued as to why there would be two photos of the same attractive woman in a book about the life of DMH I started investigating. This led to finding out that she was still very active within her church in Florida. An email to the church led to a response from Louise, which in turn led to a very pleasant telephone conversation and interview.

I published the result in the July 2013 issue of *Flat Chat*, back in the days when it was a hard copy magazine. I am pleased to say that the article was re-published throughout the Austin-Healey world.

Sadly Louise died on August 19 at 87 years of age. I thought about what to write on her and decided to re-published the original 2013 article. I think you will find it an interesting story.



The picture shows the room in which he wrote all of his books, with shelves holding his personal collection of every issue of Autocar ever published, all of

Vales cont'



the books he had written, and his extensive reference library. I'm very sad that I will no longer be able to chat with him about what the world was like when he ran the Standard-Triumph Motorsports Team in the 1950s, and knew, it seems, every influential person in the classic car world, from Donald Healey to Pat Moss. Sadly, he will never sit at that table again, working at another of his books or preparing for one of his moderator assignments at Goodwood or other international car gatherings. He was my colleague, mentor and friend for over 30 years and I will miss him.

Louise King – Austin-Healey Mystery Lady by Patrick Quinn

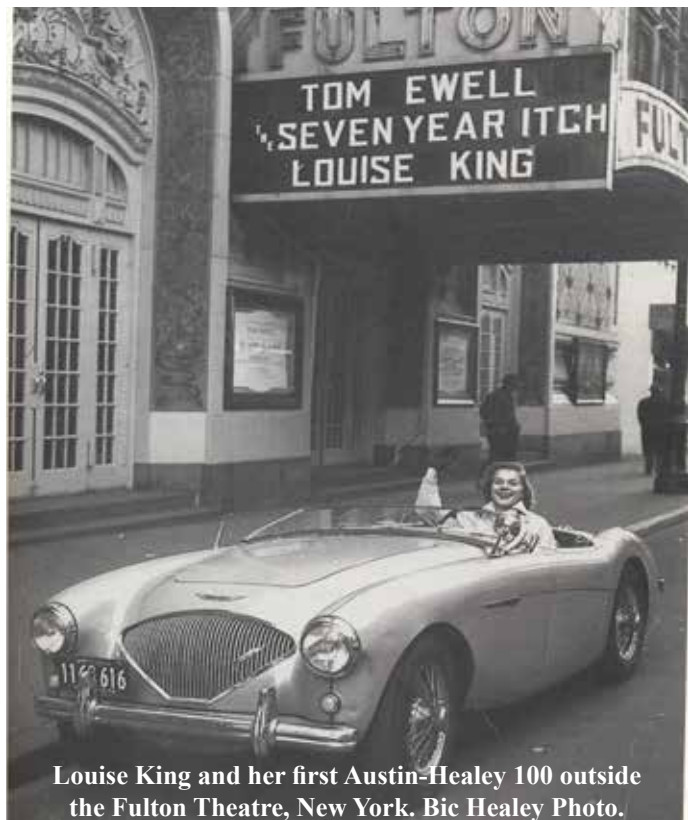
Those members who attended the Canberra National Rally certainly had a treat in the form of Bill and Wendy Ingham's Healey Boat and to see it out and about on Lake Burley Griffin was even more so.

Just beforehand, I prepared a couple of articles on Healey Boats and while doing so was reminded of a lady whose name appears in a number of publications that describe the period.

Her name is Louise King, and if you have a copy of Donald Healey – My World of Cars by Peter Garnier with Brian Healey, published by Patrick Stephens Ltd in 1989 and republished by Two Spokes Media in 2004 she is not only mentioned twice, but there are also two photos of her on pages 105 and 127.

Louise King was a Broadway actress of the period and the first photo shows her sitting in a BN1 outside the Fulton Theatre in New York. At the time she was starring in *The Seven Year Itch* alongside actor Tom Ewell, who had already made the film of the same name with Marilyn Monroe. It features that famous scene of Monroe's dress being blown upwards when she walks across a subway grate. Sadly the Fulton Theatre, Tom Ewell and Marylyn Monroe are no longer with us.

The second photo features Louise King and her friend Barbara Thomas in a Healey Boat at Nassau being steered by Stirling Moss. Interesting was that Moss did own a Healey Boat which he managed to



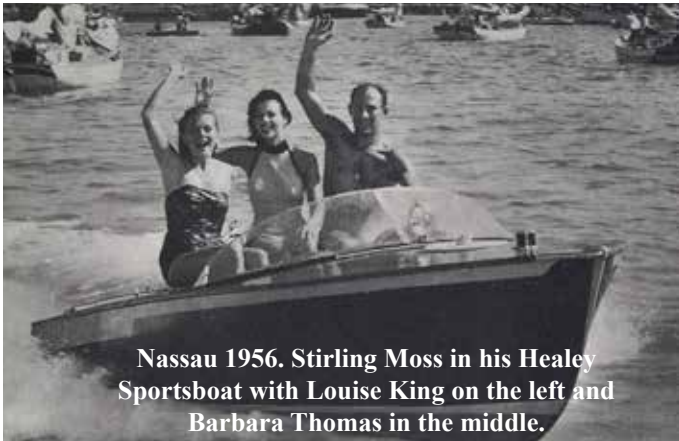
Louise King and her first Austin-Healey 100 outside the Fulton Theatre, New York. Bic Healey Photo.

put into some rocks at Nassau which resulted in its sinking. In a later interview Moss said that like all good captains he went down with his ship.

Peter Collins

With any half decent research, it shouldn't stop with just one publication. Some years back I added a copy of *Mon Ami Mate* by Chris Nixon to my library. Published by Transport Bookman Publications in 1991 it features the lives of '50s racing drivers Mike Hawthorn and Peter Collins.

Vales cont'



Nassau 1956. Stirling Moss in his Healey Sportsboat with Louise King on the left and Barbara Thomas in the middle.

It's mentioned that while Louise was starring opposite Eddie Bracken in the National Company production of *The Seven Year Itch* in Chicago, she became involved with the local sports car scene and became friendly with Jim Kimberley and Fred Wacker who was the President of the Sports Car Club of America. In 1953 after being introduced to the sports car loving bachelors, Louise decided that she must have an Austin-Healey 100. She bought one and did several rallies with it, winning the Michigan Miglia, a 1,000-mile rally round Lake Michigan. In mid-1955 Louise King travelled to Europe and purchased another 100 in London and toured Europe in the car.

Now anyone with any knowledge of Healey history will know that Peter Collins drove for Donald Healey and in particular ran the Ferrari engined car at Nassau in December 1957.

It's mentioned in *Mon Ami Mate* that Stirling Moss met Louise King through Donald Healey at the Nassau Speed Week in December 1956. Fast forward a couple of months to early February 1957 and King was playing in *The Seven Year Itch* at the Coconut Grove Playhouse in Miami. Knowing that fellow grand prix driver Peter Collins was going to be in Miami; Moss suggested that he contacts King. He does, they meet for a drink and just seven days later on Monday, February 11th 1957 Peter Collins married Louise King in Coconut Grove, Miami.

It doesn't mention how Louise became known to Donald Healey, but being aware how DMH was interested in promoting the marque through competition success and especially with well-known celebrities, her name was probably mentioned to him. In *Peter Collins – All about the boy!* by Ed McDonough, published by Mercian Manuals, Stirling



Louise King (L) and Tom Ewell on the occasion of when Marilyn Monroe visited the Broadway production of *Seven Year Itch*.

Moss is quoted as saying "Later, along came Louise who became Louise Collins. I had met her in 1956 through Donald Healey, who was a friend of hers, and through that I got to know her fairly well. It was later that I introduced her to Peter."

Ferrari

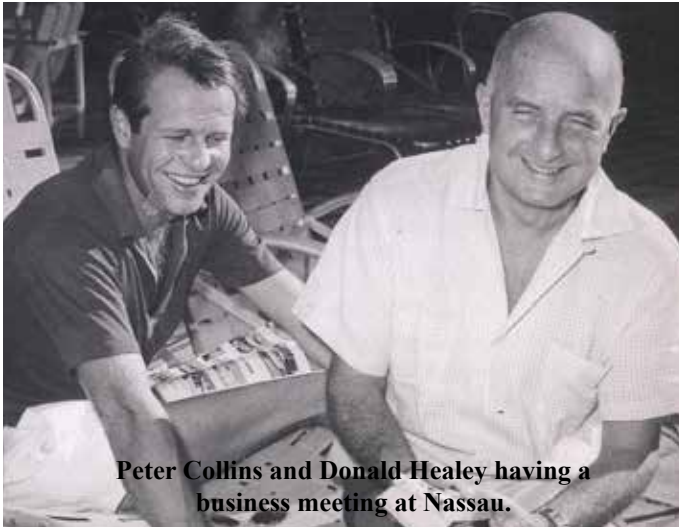
At that time Peter Collins was driving for Ferrari and had established a home at Maranello to be close to the factory. It was here that he and Louise set up home and according to *Mon Ami Mate* Donald Healey was always a welcome guest when he was in Italy.

Later it gets interesting when it's revealed that Donald had bought a factory in Nassau and had plans in his mind to assemble Healey cars and boats for direct shipping the short distance to Miami. When Peter Collins said that he was thinking of getting out of motor racing, DMH suggested to Collins that he might like to manage it. It was to be discussed in depth when Collins was to drive for Healey in the 1957 Bahamas Speed Week.

Nothing came from the proposal, but Collins' drive at Nassau in December 1957 is of interest as it was behind the wheel of the Ferrari Healey. This car was a six-cylinder chassis with extended front and rear bodywork and fitted with a four-cylinder 2.5 litre Ferrari DOHC engine. However it was not without its faults, such as when it had a full load of fuel the ground clearance was zero, so much so that the exhaust pipe acted as the suspension.

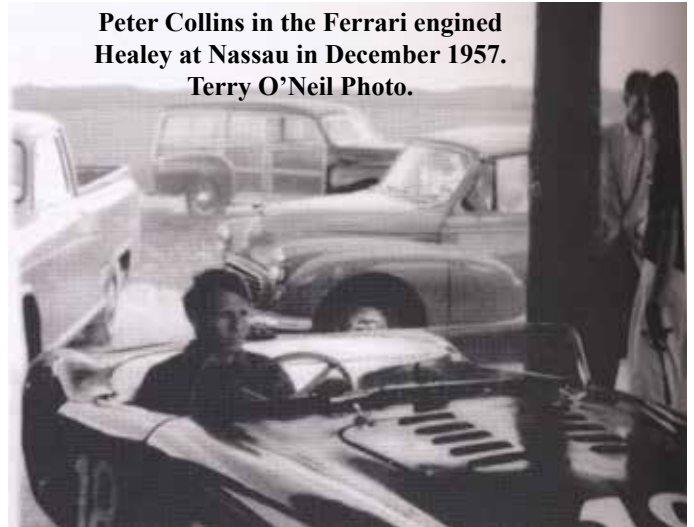
Despite this, Collins won Class D (up to 3-litres) in the car, but it was decided that the combination of the Ferrari engine and Austin-Healey chassis wasn't

Vales cont'



Peter Collins and Donald Healey having a business meeting at Nassau.

Peter Collins in the Ferrari engined Healey at Nassau in December 1957. Terry O'Neil Photo.



a success and it was confined to history. However the car was run again with a six-cylinder Austin engine with Roy Salvadori driving and found to be quicker and more reliable.

The 1958 season saw Collins once again part of the Ferrari team. It could be said that Peter and Louise were enjoying wedded bliss as they travelled every together, spending as much time in each other's company as possible. For instance for the Argentine GP held on January 19th they travelled by ship from New York, a journey of two weeks.

In both Mon Ami Mate and Peter Collins – All about the boy! it's mentioned that Collins was a favourite of Enzo Ferrari and goes on to say that Louise was taken under the wing of Laura (Mrs) Ferrari, even if they couldn't speak a word of the other's language.

Sadly it all wasn't to last as on August 3rd 1958 during the German Grand Prix, Peter Collins crashed his Ferrari while coming second behind the Vanwall of Tony Brooks. Louise Collins was taken to the hospital, but her husband had died in the helicopter on the way.

After the race Louise returned to Italy and reports say that the Ferraris were very kind towards her. However there was nothing to keep her there, so she returned to the US to take up her acting career.

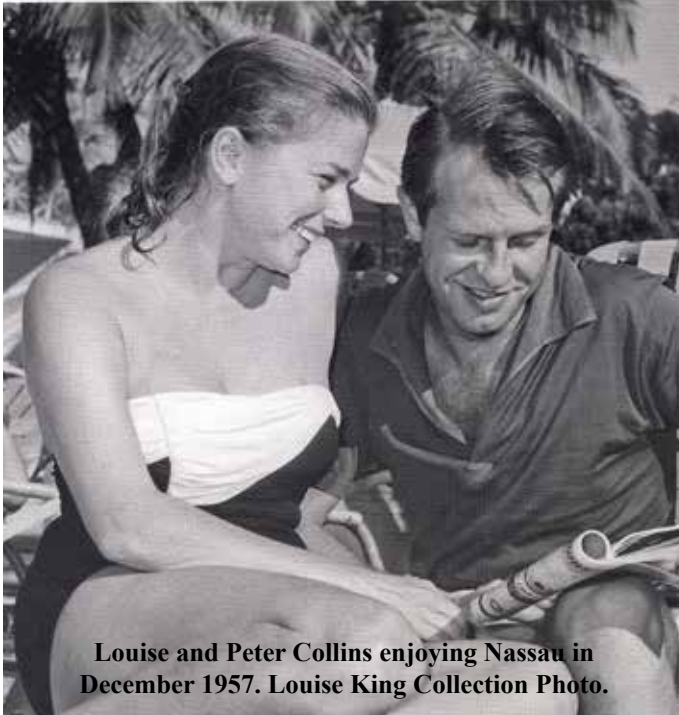
A Word with Louise

Certainly it's an interesting story with an Austin-Healey connection, but it's also a story of love and passion which makes you think what would have happened if Peter Collins had given motor racing away after the end of the 1958 season.

All of which made me wonder about what happened to Louise King and through the wonders of the Internet I soon found out that she is still very much with us and involved with her church in Florida. So after a short explanatory email to the church's administration I received one back from Louise King. I had to ask the obvious question to which the answer was that she would be more than happy for me to call her to talk about her days of being involved with Donald Healey the Austin-Healey marque.

"My first car was an Austin-Healey." Louise answered my first question. "I was starring in the Seven Year Itch in Chicago and became involved in the sports car crowd and joined in a few rallies. I got to know them all quite well and in the Austin-Healey took part in the Michigan Miglia and won it outright. The car was blue and I recall one time when I was driving down a highway with two others, one white and the other red making a very patriotic picture, but as we took up all three lanes and we drove right at the speed limit this was not appreciated. A very nice policeman told us so! I'm afraid the Austin-Healey didn't last all that long. I was driving from Washington, DC to Baltimore, Maryland and involved in an accident which completely wrecked the car."

"I first met Donald when I had driven over to San Francisco in 1954. I took a photograph of him at the Huntington Hotel on August 26th 1954. The date sticks in my mind as I know that he and Roy Jackson-Moore were at the Bonneville Salt Flats from the 22nd to the 24th so they must have come straight from the Flats to the bars of San Francisco! Those were the days... I'm sure that he wanted to do some publicity stuff with my Austin-Healey and our show, which is



Louise and Peter Collins enjoying Nassau in December 1957. Louise King Collection Photo.

how we met. It was Donald who introduced me to Stirling Moss in 1955, who I was to date for a time when we were later both in Nassau."

"In 1955 I went to the 12 hour race in Sebring." Louise added. "That was followed by my first trip to Europe where I met up with Stirling again and was introduced to Ken Gregory who was Stirling's manager and later became Donald Healey's PR man. While in London I bought another Austin-Healey and drove around Europe and ended up in Monte Carlo for the Grand Prix. I ran into Donald on Capri and we both went to Mt Vesuvius near Naples together."

"It was Stirling who told Peter to call me in Coconut Grove and seven days later Peter and I were married. Not long after we were married I sold the second Austin-Healey."

Nassau

I was interested in Louise's recollections of the times they were in Nassau.

"I went to Nassau a lot which was wonderful. It had a big social scene!" Louise answered. "I recall very clearly when Peter was driving for Donald in 1957 we spent a lot of our time running about in Squealey Boats and attending social events held by Sir Sydney and Lady Greta Oakes, the force behind the Nassau races. I remember Roy Jackson-Moore being fascinated by Greta Oakes and looking back to then I can say that a lot of people were fascinated by a lot of other people."

"Donald was thinking of setting up a factory in Nassau to make speed boats. It was the intention that Peter would operate it after he stopped racing, but nothing came from it. Perhaps it was just a daydream as no plans were put into place."

"After Peter was killed in 1958 I kept up my friendship with Donald." Louise added. "I remember some years later Donald mentioned to me that after the last Austin-Healey was built that there was to be no more car related things for him to be involved with. However, all that changed for him during the 1970s when the US Austin-Healey clubs started to invite him to meetings and different events."

"By that stage I was living in New York and Donald would always come and stay before and after his American tour. I remember quite clearly how excited he was at the thought of being invited to go to Australia in 1977. It was something that he really enjoyed being involved with."

"I went back to the stage when I returned to the US." Louise said. "That was a tour with Peter Ustinov in Romanoff and Juliet, followed by quite a bit of television work. I married again, this time in Canada, but five years later I got throat cancer so after a very serious operation I left him and returned to the States. I am now cancer free for forty-two years. I later opened a kitchen shop in Connecticut and then moved into real estate. Now I live in Florida and am very much involved with my church."

"The last time I was in England and Cornwall it wasn't long after John Healey died. I managed to meet up with Bic Healey, but have lost touch since."

Many thanks to Louise King for her time, as it answers the question as to why her photo appears twice in Donald Healey – My World of Cars.

By the way I also passed on her email address to Bic Healey and vice versa.



BJ7 WHEELS RE-TYRED

By Allan Whitehouse

With several of our Austin-Healey Owners Club members having suffered tyre issues recently, I thought it might be prudent to look at the condition of those fitted to my BJ7.

I knew that I had been running a set of Yokohamas on 72 spoke Dayton wire wheels for several years, with plenty of tread still left on them, but I was most surprised when I read on the side of the tyres the date of manufacture as 2003. These had been on the car for 18 years!

So, with my mind made up to replace them, I sought advice from a few other Austin-Healey owners (thank you all for your input – it was greatly appreciated), looked on-line at well-known brands offering tyre sizes to suit my wheels and studied the various reviews of each.

The characteristics I wanted were good grip, high control on both wet and dry roads, high margins of safety during braking, good comfort and low road noise. As the BJ7 covers very few kms per year, I did not need a “fuel-efficient” tyre, as these are made of a relatively hard compound which sticks less to the road, making it easier for the car to roll along, hence offering a level of fuel saving. The compromise with this is decreased braking ability and poorer cornering and handling capabilities. The brands I considered included Michelin, Pirelli, Yokohama, Kumho, Hankook and Dunlop but in the end I selected Continental's Ultra Contact UC6 tyres.

suspension and which has provided excellent service over many years. I elected to take the wheels off the 3000 in my garage rather than drive up to Paul's workshop, as I wanted to clean the rims and spokes thoroughly, grease the splined hubs, paint the rear brake drums and label each tyre with its position, size and direction of rotation.



Inner rims polished



The rest polished by hand



Wheels and hubs greased.



Wheels removed and cleaned

I placed an order for these through Paul Elliot at TyreSmart Auto, Mortlake, a local auto mechanic business which specialises in tyres, brakes and

I considered this labelling necessary for several reasons – the rear rims are slightly offset with a tyre width of 205mm while the front rims take a 195mm. Also, the Ultra Contact UC6 tyres are asymmetric, so they have an inner and outer side and I wanted each wheel to go back on the same hub as before.

Re-Tyred Cont



The next important job was to have the newly-shod wheels balanced correctly. This is best achieved using the Club's special wire wheel balance kit (developed originally thanks to Barry Campbell and now held by club member Geoff Smith). A dummy splined hub is fitted onto the balance machine's spindle and the wire wheel is mounted and secured with the kit's "knockoff" nut. Finally, the machine's wing arm is locked into place. This process ensures that the wire wheel is correctly located on its hub's inner and outer bearing surfaces.

After having the new tyres fitted and wheels balanced, and with splines greased and rear brake drums painted, I put all four wheels back on the car. The following day I took the Healey for a short drive (to the grocery store of course) and was amazed by the improvement in the way it handled. It felt as though power steering had been fitted. No more having to wrench the steering wheel at low speed with both arms, while cornering the car could definitely be described as being "on rails".

Looking back, getting new tyres for the BJ7 was a very good decision and one I'll probably consider doing again in another 18 years.

Austin Westminster Overdrive

by Denis Kasza

Some members might recall my mention of overdrive problems with my car.

The electro-mechanical Borg-Warner overdrive is rare in Australia these days and wasn't all that common in the '50s and '60s. It's sometimes considered inconvenient to operate and too complex to repair, compared to the excellent and fully electrically operated Laycock de Normanville unit, but I do enjoy the more convoluted method of operation, especially the kick down.

The Borg-Warner wasn't featured in many British cars back in the day. BMC fitted it as standard to most of its mid-50s to mid-60s six-cylinder saloons and as an option with its medium-sized fours. Ford offered it with the Zodiacs. It was used in more than ten million American cars and trucks from the mid-30s to the early 1970s.

When I bought my '61 Westminster in May '20, the over-



drive's kick down function was very reluctant to oblige and there was plenty of throttle slop. I also found that the overdrive wouldn't re-engage once the car was warm, but after a rest stop, it usually got going again. I suspected that there might've been a problem with the governor and after the gearbox had been reconditioned, the overdrive wouldn't engage at all. Awkward access to the kick down switch, the associated throttle linkages and the governor caused frustration and I found the tests described in the workshop manual almost unintelligible. Helpful advice indicated that the main issue was probably some minor electrical glitch and I began to ask auto-electricians if they could sort it out.

After searching for quite a while, I found that Dave of Kirrawee Auto Electrics was willing to take a look. He cleaned up the very dirty kick down switch and its wiring, sorted out the throttle linkages and identified that the governor was faulty. A temporary fix was to bypass the governor with a dash mounted switch. Dave Faruggia of the NSW Wolseley Club has kindly donated a clean governor, which will be installed soon.

I'm thankful that I can now enjoy highway cruising and overtaking as the manufacturer intended, limited of course to within five kilometres of home, which in my case means Southern Cross Drive, Sydney.

Tasmania Tour - 2022

At the request of the AHOC I have been asked to organise another Tasmania Tour in 2022.

If you wish to express your interest, please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

How I made my Windscreen Wiper Two-Speed for less than \$100

By Ray Roberts

Lucas did this by adding a 10 ohm resistor in the motor housing that could be switched in and out of the field winding.

Another way to achieve this on an Austin-Healey, is adding an external 10 ohm 10 watt resistor, that can be switched in and out of the field winding. 1 x normal speed and 2 x normal speed.

What I used for the job:

1x10 ohm 10 watt resistor- \$2 from Jaycar

1x3 position switch, my one was a spare BJ8 head light switch with terminals marked 4,6,7,8 this arrangement keeps the parking function. Same as a MGB switch.

What I did:

Removed the wiper motor, there are some tricks to this.

All work on the wiper motor is done internally on terminal 1, where the park wire and the field winding are soldered together. I snipped the field wire off (single small wire), cleaned its end and soldered a wire to it long enough to reach the wiper switch position on the dashboard. I use heat shrink and sealant to insulate and hold the new wire in place as it is hanging free. I drilled a hole in the cap of the motor

to pass the wire through, then put it back together.

What I found:

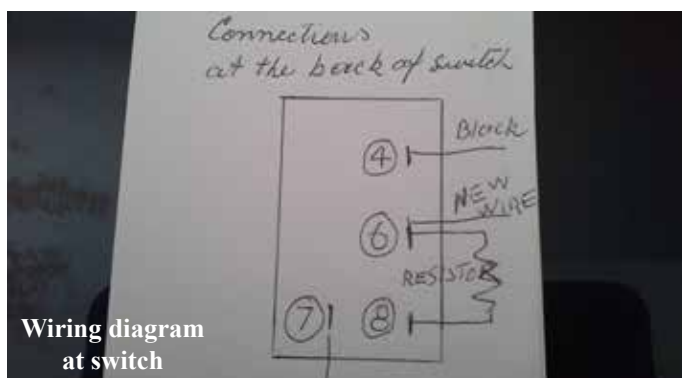
It was easier to work on terminal 1 by removing the field winding from the motor case. The winding is held by two self tapping screws into the magnetic shoes. Be careful on reassembly that there is clearance of armature to field to avoid poling.

The resistor gets hot at fast speed, but should not be noticed.

Some electrical calcs: Current = I, Volts = E, Ohms = Resistance = R, Watts = $I \times I \times R$, $I = E/R$, $I = 12/10 = 1.2$ amps @ normal speed, $R = 10 + 10 = 20$ ohms, $I = 12/20 = .6$ amps @ 2x speed. Watts at resistor = $.6 \times .6 \times 10 = 3.6$ watts ok as resistor is rated at 10 watts.

Wiring at switch connect terminal 4 black wire as for the old switch, terminal 6 new wire + one side of 10 ohm resistor, terminal 7 green/black from old switch. Terminal 8 the other side of the 10 ohm resistor. I used insulated push-on connectors to insure adequate electrical clearance to any metal frame.

Savings ex-Jaguar two-speed wiper \$400 and ex-Jaguar two-speed switch \$200.



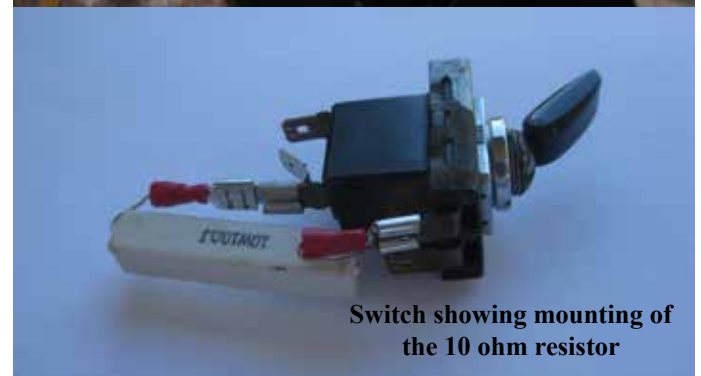
Wiring diagram
at switch



New wire passing
through end plate



LHS is terminal 1 where
wire is to be snipped off in
this case it's the black wire



Switch showing mounting of
the 10 ohm resistor

A Scare and a New Screen

By Gordon Lynas

I had taken Henrietta (Lynas 100 PQ) out for a spin around our local area. It was glorious, with Henrietta humming along beautifully. All was well with my world. That was until I came to the top of Tumble-Down Dick, the hill leading to Terrey Hills. I'd had great vision all trip until the sun shone directly onto my 25 year old windscreen. My clear view of the road ahead suddenly turned into an orange glow as the sun shone on it at just the right angle to stop me seeing through it. This was particularly unnerving as a few years ago a woman was killed on this very stretch of road. She drove straight into the back of a slow truck, apparently blinded by the sun, just as I was. I was luckier. There wasn't a slow truck hiding in that brilliant sunny glow.

When I got home, I had a close look at the screen. It was peppered with minute chips, obviously caused by sand and grit hitting the screen over many years. In ordinary light it looked fine, but with the sun on it at the right angle, it became opaque. It was time for a new screen. Fortuitously, at the next General Meeting Colin Rule announced that he had located a supplier of windscreen glass in Queensland and was looking for orders so he could buy a batch for Club members. I placed my order.

A while later, the screen had been delivered to Sydney, and after many delays I finally collected it from George Goodare who had very kindly stored it for me. I ordered a screen rubber pack from The Healey Factory and after it had arrived, I could get started.

The first job was to unbolt the screen from the car. Being a '100' that is very simple as it is designed to fold down should the driver really want to collect flies and grit in his eyes as he (or she) drives along. In my more foolish youth, I did indeed enjoy cruising through beautiful country with the screen down, but that was in England where the flies are nowhere near so populous, and the rain keeps the sand and grit down. Anyway, I took out the two securing bolts and lifted off the screen.

The last time I had had it apart was when I installed this piece of glass back around 1982, so I was expecting some difficulty in dismantling the screen frame. It is held together by eight small screws. Two at each corner of the screen which screw into steel

brackets. I was expecting these to be well corroded, however, imagine my surprise when they all unscrewed without trouble. It seems I had used stainless steel screws, and the brackets were remarkably corrosion free.



Windscreen frame screws

The frame is wider at the bottom than the top, so I decided to remove the longer bottom rail first. In order to do that it is necessary to peel the bottom seal rubber out of the frame for a couple of inches at each side to reveal the screws that hold the bottom rail to the side rails. It isn't necessary to remove all of the seal rubber, unless you are going to take the opportunity to fit a new seal. Mine had been replaced when the body was tidied up ten years ago, so was still in good condition. If it had been the same age as the glazing I'm sure I would have needed a new seal.

After removing the two screws at each side, the bottom rail can be very carefully eased off the glass. The frame rails on a '100' are quite small section channel. They are therefore easily bent (but difficult to return to the correct curvature if one should become bent). So, this is not a job to be rushed or forced. The old glass had been a very tight fit in the frame, which of course is what is needed if rain isn't to leak into the driver's lap! Having been in place for nearly 40 years, it took a little gentle prising to start it moving, however, once started it wasn't too difficult to continue easing it off the old glass, being careful not to bend the rail, or chip the glass. (Yes, it is being replaced, but who wants to work with glass splinters in the work area?)

Next, I undid one side at the top and removed one side pillar, and then the other. The channels can then be cleaned. Mine had various blobs of silicone sealant at the bottom corners, as well as the odd bit of sticky old rubber seal here and there.

Screen cont'



New screen and rails ready for reassembly

The rubber is intended to hold the glass tightly in the frame. It is therefore intended to be a tight fit, which means that lubrication is required in order that the glass can slip into the rubber and the rubber into the frame. I happened to have some 'O' ring grease in my store and used that. Diluted washing up detergent also works well.

[I had one problem here in that the glazing rubber supplied by The Healey Factory is the same as that used on my old screen. However, the old glazing was 7 mm thick. The new one is only 5.4mm. On fitting the rail over the rubber and on to the glazing it was very obvious that the glazing rubber was too thin. Luckily Clark Rubber could supply some 2 mm thick rubber which was a much better fit.]



Rubber grease and frame screws

Initially I tried wrapping the rubber around the glass and then tried to slip the frame rail over the rubber. This wasn't successful. The week before doing this job, I had been replacing a fly screen, and I had a very neat little roller that I had used to push the locking rubber into the flyscreen frame. It was just right for seating the glazing rubber into the frame preparatory to sliding the glazing into the rubber.



Using fly screen roller to install rubber in frame



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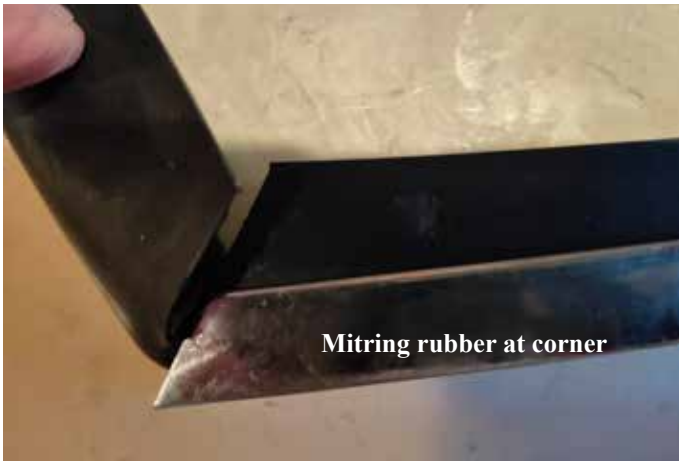


Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsash.com.au
 13 Waltham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Screen cont'

Once seated I roughly mitred the rubber at each end of the rail. In fitting the glass the rubber can move and stretch, so I left the rubber a bit long at this stage. Final trim can be done once the glazing has been inserted into the rail. I fitted the top rail first, so this was the first corner to be mitred.

**Mitring rubber at corner**

With the top rail on and centred on the glazing, the side rails can be slipped over the glazing and screwed to the top rail. Being careful to keep the side rails on the glazing, the bottom rail can be slipped over the glazing, the rubber trim mitred and the frame screwed up. To prevent the glazing from impacting on the bracket corners I glued a couple of layers of rubber offcut in the bottom of the rail at each end, close to, but clear of the brackets. If the glazing moves in the frame, it should be prevented by the rubber from hitting the bracket.

**Top rail screwd to one side**

Finally, the bottom seal can be carefully slipped back into the slot in the bottom rail, and the completed screen can be returned to the car.

**Bottom rubber reinserted**

And that is how my car got a nice new windscreen. A professional screen fitter may well have gone about it differently, but the way I did it worked, and was easy to do.

**I Can See Clearly Now The Screen's Installed****Le Mans 1953 NOJ 391. Drivers Bequart and Wilkins.**

Adventures cont'

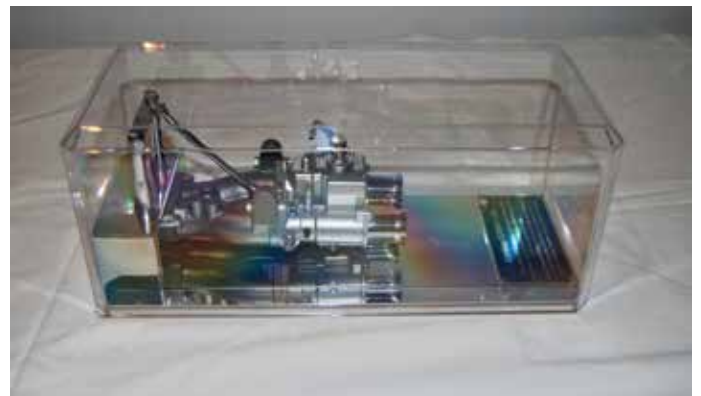
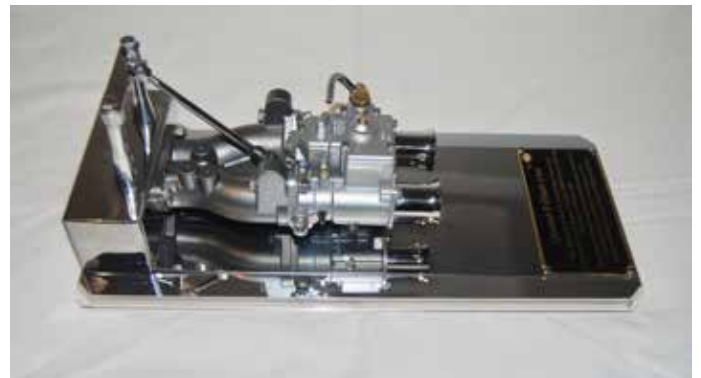
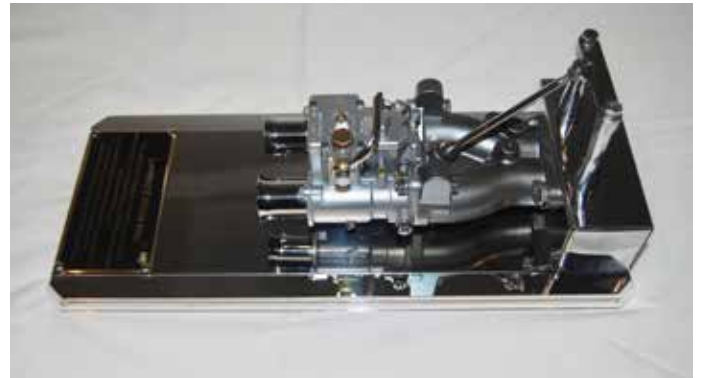
Kincumber Happenings

By Colin Rule

Unfortunately no gatherings, but plenty of catch up phone calls and emails happening just to stay in touch. I have had some encouraging reports on engine rebuilds and cars having a birthday with paint touch up work, so to speak.

Here in my workshop at South Kincumber I have totally finished my BN2 (230294), all wrapped up ready for judging whenever that is going to happen due to the extended lockdowns.

In the meantime after having a little bit of personal plumbing work done five weeks ago on the old ticker, I have been amusing myself with light duties, building another standalone half-scale model 45DCOE13 Weber carburettor. Number 002.



Now fully recovered, I'm in full swing dismantling HBJ8L/27342, an Austin-Healey I purchased from Mike Gates in the US in 2013. The car has only travelled 34,000 mile from new and was taken off the road in 1977. Mike was the second owner of the car.





So as you can see if this lockdown continues, I am going to get a lot of work done, all going well.

I am looking forward to the day when we can all meet again for our first Saturday of the month Austin-Healey Workshop. In the meantime, make the most of the lockdown; tweak your Austin-Healey ready for Summer!

Stay safe everyone and happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.



Three weeks after his birthday, Eastern Suburbs member Bryan Levy received a belated surprise present.

A painting of his BJ8 specially commissioned by his family from a local artist.

Needless to say it takes pride of place framed and on the wall.

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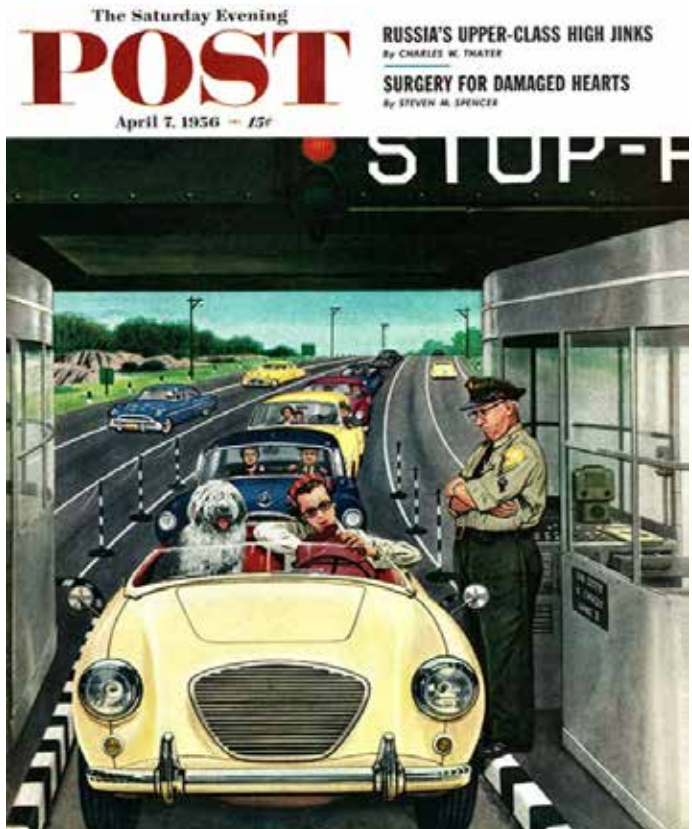
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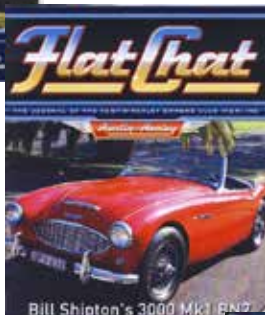
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It's time to buy a torch for your garage; like, right now.

By David Conwill

Many thanks to www.hemmings.com for this useful article on adding a little heat to your garage. It was originally published on 18 August 2021. If you would like to read other great articles have a look at www.hemmings.com



You don't want your car stranded on jack stands just because you can't get something apart.



Even a small torch can prevent hours of wrestling with stuck parts. No, the flame is nowhere near that new brake hose.

Back in April, my eldest and I brought a '62 Corvair back from Michigan, and I've been working on it ever since. It's an Oakland, California-built car that lived in Michigan starting around 1972, so it's a little rough around the edges. Oh well, so am I. Several weeks ago, I blew a brake hose and had to limp home using the parking brake. I immediately ordered all the parts to repair the damage and upgrade to a dual master cylinder setup (stay tuned for more details on that) and set to work using penetrating oil on all the hardware that would need to come apart. For the most part, that actually worked... except where it didn't. I couldn't put much torque on the fittings using tubing wrenches and I hoped to save the steel hard lines, which were all in decent shape, so cutting the line to get on a socket or box-end was something I wanted to avoid.

At long last, I was faced with the indisputable need that every garage has to have a torch on hand. Heating* and cooling a rusted joint is the ideal way to get it apart without destroying it. I quenched my heated pieces with WD-40. As it heat cycles, the metal moves for you (even better if you have two metals with different expansion rates) and breaks the bonds of corrosion. Using "the blue-tip wrench" saved a lot of parts and a lot of effort. I can't believe I went so long without one. On my brake system, the hard lines meet the hoses where they pass through a bracket in the fender wells. The junction is held in place with clips on either side. Both connections on the driver's side were completely frozen and I nearly rounded off the nut on the rear hard line when my tubing wrench spread. Judicious application of heat got the rear junction apart and saved the day. Up front, I still couldn't save the parts--but thankfully the replacement hard line was less than a foot long and was easy to replace.

Even the mixed success on this particular project hasn't dissuaded me from the absolute necessity of having a torch around. In fact, now I use the torch for everything and it has dramatically changed the amount of effort it takes to work on old cars. I even find myself ever-alert to new projects where I can use the torch. For example, I just watched a short video of a fellow using one to solder battery cable

Torch cont'

ends and it has renewed my daydream of battery relocation and 00-gauge leads. But, I digress. If you don't have a torch, you want one. Trust me. It doesn't have to be an oxy-acetylene setup, either. I've done all this with a handheld Propane/MAPP-fueled unit bought at my local big-box store.



Yes, the brand name is identifiable here. No, this isn't a review--just a general endorsement of torch ownership.

The only thing fancy about it is that it uses a hose between the bottle and the torch, providing a little more flexibility under the car versus a fixed tank. I paid a little over \$70 for mine, but you can get a fixed-tank setup for as little as \$20.

* A quick note here to remind you that if there's still fluid in your brake system, it will boil and expand when you heat it, rupturing something. I was "fortunate" in that my brake lines had already emptied themselves on the road. Also watch out for fuel lines, flammable undercoating, and other things that don't react well to fire.

For Sale

Philip Bloom offers the following for sale on behalf of ex-member Tony Williams.

If interested Philip can be contacted on 0425 363 469

- Workbench 57in x 102in x 37in high complete with vice.
- Buff and wire brush
- Belt sander and grinder with spare belts
- Grinder and belt
- Standalone Buff and wire brush on pedestal
- Two jack stands small \$20 each
- Two jack stands large \$25 each
- Set allen keys metric and SAE
- Taps and dies set whitworth
- BN1 diff in good condition BN1 suit restoration \$300
- Vacuum gauge to check carbs \$30

Philip also offers for sale - one 2 inch SU \$300 each and four x 1 3/4 SU \$250 each

For Sale

So good it was sent to me twice

Free to a good home!

While exploring the depths of his under house garage space, Russell Kelly tells us that he found four Big Healey wire wheels complete with very old tyres.

Russell is offering them free of charge to a good home, but does recommend that the tyres be discarded. The wheels are located at Castle Hill.

Russell can be contacted on 0416 225 765.

Bleeding Austin-Healey Four Wheel Drum Brakes

by Michael Salter

Adjusting the brakes and getting all the air out of the hydraulic brake system to produce a “hard” pedal can be particularly difficult when dealing with the all drum systems of 100 and 100/6 Austin-Healeys.

Here are tips that I have found make the job a little easier.

CHECK THE ARC OF THE BRAKE SHOES.

If new or relined brake shoes are being installed or the brake drums have been turned it is very important to check the curvature of the shoe relative to the drum. Ideally the shoe will contact the drum throughout its entire arc.



If the shoe can be “rocked” in the drum because the radius of the surface of the friction material is smaller than that of the drum, the shoes need to be re-arc'd to match the drum. If the arc of the shoes is smaller than that of the drum pedal travel will be wasted as the force from the wheel cylinder bends the shoe to shape.

Most companies that reline shoes have a brake shoe grinder to do this job.

SET THE BRAKE SHOE STEADY POSTS CORRECTLY

Behind each of the eight brake shoes is a “steady” post which is used to tilt the shoe to keep its friction surface parallel to the surface of the drum. These posts have little felt wicks on them to keep them lubricated where they contact the brake shoe.



If the shoes have been changed or relined or the drums have been turned it is important to re-adjust the steady posts which is achieved by turning the post after loosening the lock-nut.



I have found that the easiest method is to first unscrew a post until the shoe starts to drag when the wheel is turned, then screw the post in until it produces the same amount of drag. Setting the post to the midpoint of these two positions will result in correct adjustment.

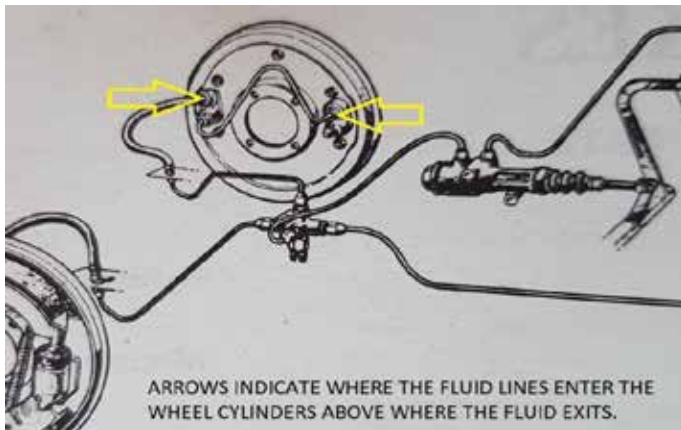
This adjustment method takes a little practice, but is quite simple once mastered.

BACK OFF THE FRONT BRAKE SNAIL ADJUSTERS BEFORE THE INITIAL BLEEDING

I know this sounds counter intuitive, but the way the front wheel cylinders are mounted and “plumbed” makes getting all the air out of them very difficult because the port where fluid from the master cyl-

Brakes cont'

inder enters the cylinder is above the port where it exits on its route to the bleed screw.



I'm sure the Girling engineers had very good reasons for this arrangement but I have no idea what those ideas were, however the net result is that as fluid passes through each cylinder during the bleeding process it is very easy for an air "bubble" to remain in the cylinder and, the further the piston is from fully retracted, the larger that bubble tends to be.

By backing off the brake adjusters to fully retract the pistons the amount of air that becomes trapped in each cylinder is minimised, not eliminated but minimised.

BLEED THE SYSTEM BY GRAVITY

Furiously pumping the brake pedal in an attempt to get fluid through the system usually results in aeration of the fluid and serious frustration.

I have had the greatest success by just ensuring that the reservoir is filled and then opening the bleed screws on the cylinders until fluid starts to drip out of them. You can do them all at once or one at a time, you can start with the one furthest from the master cylinder or the one closest it doesn't matter. All that is important is to ensure that you do not

allow the reservoir level to get too low.

Once fluid starts to run out of a bleed screw in a solid stream close the bleed screw and immediately use water to flush away any spilled fluid. When all four bleed screws have been gravity bled in this manner then adjust the brakes.

If you have done everything correctly you should have a good "hard" pedal.

ANOTHER TRICK

Occasionally, despite ones best efforts, the brake pedal is still "soft". When this occurs, it is often useful to try to isolate the source of the problem.

This takes two people and a special tool namely a pair of Vicegrip pliers.

There is a special tool for the job, but Vicegrips, when used carefully are much better.

Use the Vicegrips to gently clamp off the flow in one of the three brake flex hoses. **DO NOT SQUEEZE THE HOSE TOO TIGHTLY.** Just enough to stop the flow of fluid.



Now have your assistant pump the pedal gently until a firm pedal is established and, while the assistant maintains pressure on the pedal, rapidly release the Vicegrips.

As the Vicegrips release the pedal will be felt to drop a little (or a lot). Repeat this procedure on each brake hose. If a more significant drop of the pedal occurs on either of the front brakes or on the rear brakes that is the brake(s) to check for problems.



BEAUTIFULLY FAST,
THE AUSTIN HEALEY

This is an unusual picture. It shows an Austin Healey at rest; and that is one thing this magnificent sports car rarely is. For when you think of an Austin Healey, you think of beauty in action. You think of an immensely powerful sports car going ahead like streak lightning. You think of a speedometer that goes 70... 80... 90... 100 and more. You think of the sheer excitement and exhilaration of being at the wheel of a record-breaker.

But the Austin Healey is not only beautiful to watch and beautiful to drive. The car itself is a beautiful engineering and design job. Its surging power comes from a superb 2.6 litre O.H.V. engine. Its wonderfully finished body is built on aerodynamic lines for speed. Its controls (one of the results of racing experience) are handily placed for sports driving. Its boot is particularly large for this kind of car. One final word. The upholstery is real leather, the carpeting is luxurious, the accessories are part and parcel of the standard equipment. Considering all this and the class of the car, the price of the Austin Healey is remarkably reasonable: £806 plus £401.

AUSTIN HEALEY

The Austin Motor Company Limited, Longbridge, Birmingham.

The above period advertisement for the new Austin-Healey is a little hard to read, but perhaps the below will make it easier.

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Austin-Healey

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